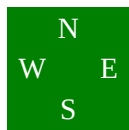


Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 7 6
♥ 9 7 3
♦ 10 6 4 3
♣ Q 8 7

♠ J 10 5
♥ A J 6 4
♦ A J 7
♣ A J 4



♠ K Q 9 4 2
♥ 5
♦ Q 8 2
♣ 9 6 5 3

♠ 8 3
♥ K Q 10 8 2
♦ K 9 5
♣ K 10 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North
than likely a defender will win the third ♦. He won't be happy about it, though.

[showcards N:H8,CK,CT,C2 S:HJ,CA,CJ,C4]

Whichever defender wins the ♦Q is end-played. If he plays a ♦ or a ♠ you will ruff in one hand and discard a ♣ loser from the other. But if he leads a ♣ instead you no longer have a ♣ loser.

On this Deal an elimination play will guarantee that you make your contract.

However, it also guarantees that you will not make an overtrick.

If you try the two finesses instead you **MIGHT** make an overtrick, but you also might go down 1.

Decide for yourself!

South first transfers you to ♥s, then gives you a choice of which game to play. Knowing you have an 9-card trump fit, you choose 4♥.

North is to play 4♥. The defenders start with ♠K, ♠Q, ♠A.

In addition to the two ♠s already lost you have a potential loser in each minor suit. On the plus side, you have a finesse position in ♦s and a two-way finesse in ♣s. If you work both finesses successfully you make an overtrick - if both fail you will be down 1. Or, you could try for a 100% sure end-play.

Ruff the ♠A with dummy's ♥10 and pull trumps (three rounds).

Eliminate ♦s by playing ♦K, ♦A, ♦J. If you are REALLY lucky the ♦Q will fall doubleton, but more

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 5 3

♥ Q 8 7 2

♦ 3

♣ J 8 5

♠ A

♥ A K 6

♦ A K Q 9 7 4

♣ A Q 9

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 7 4

♥ 10 9 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ K 10 2

♠ 8 6 2

♥ J 3

♦ J 10 6 5

♣ 7 6 4 3

West

North

East

South

2 ♣

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4 ♦

Pass

6 ♦

All Pass

6 ♦ by South

At last it is time to play ♣s. Lead a ♣ from your hand and play dummy's ♣9 if West plays low. East will win the trick but will be end-played, forced to either play a ♣ back to dummy's ♣A Q, or give you a ruff-sluff.

If West puts on either the ♣10 or ♣J you play dummy's ♣Q. If East can win with the ♣K he will once again be end-played, forced to either play a ♣ back to dummy's ♣A 9, or give you a ruff-sluff.

The A Q 9 combination is interesting. Obviously if you have A Q 10 it works very well in an end-play situation.

As you see, A Q 9 actually works just as well.

You naturally respond 2 ♦ to North's strong 2 ♣ opener. Before you know it you are playing a slam - with your mighty 2-point hand! South plays 6 ♦. West leads the ♠Q.

If the contract appears to depend upon a finesse, try to find another way. Here, you can always try the ♣ finesse, but maybe you can eliminate ♠s and see what happens.

Win the ♠A, play the ♦4 to the ♦10, and ruff a ♠ with the ♦Q. Both opponents followed to the trump.

Play the ♦7 to the ♦J and ruff the last ♠ with the ♦K.

Having eliminated the ♦s and ♠s, now remove the ♥s. Play ♥A, ♥K, and ruff a ♥.